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# Babur Returns to Samarkand

While Babur was on his route after crossing Yari, Qambar Ali came to see him. He had kept Sangzar in absolute control. Abu'l Qasim Kohbur and Ibrahim Tarkhān proved to be loyal enough, and in good faith sent efficient men for Babur's service. Babur along with his men without, wasting any time, barged into Asfidik, one of the Yar Yilaq villages. At the same time, Shaybāni Khān was lying near Khwaja Didar with around 4000 Aūzbegs and many more soldiers gathered locally. He had passed on the governance of Samarkand at the hands of Jan Wafa Mīrzā. And in that period, he was in the fort with around 600 men. Hamza Sulṭān and Mahdi Sulṭān were lying near the fort as a quail reserve. Babur did not have a group of more than twenty dozen men.

Despite having a lesser number of men, Babur decided to go ahead after having a broad discussion with his begs around this matter. They assumed it to be a right move considering that Shaybāni Khān had taken possession of Samarkand very recently and he hardly had any connection with the people. They were convinced that once they got in through the ladders, leaving Jan Wafa Mīrzā's men surprised, the Samarkandis would come in support.

However, Babur was still clouded by doubt about the loyalty of Samarkandis post his attack. But then Babur was convinced that even if they didn't shower any help, they wouldn't stand by Aūzbegs opposing him either. He wove his thoughts further into the future and said that 'once Samarkand comes in our hands, whatever was Allah's will, would happen'.

And with full confidence and faith in Allah, Babur rode out of Yar Yilaq after the mid-day prayer. They reached Khān Yurti by midnight. The news reached them that the Samarkandis somehow knew of Babur's approach.

Babur felt disturbed. His idea to take them by surprise wasn't going to work now, given the fact Babur had fewer troops in comparison. He decided not to go further. Sleeplessly riding for the whole night, they once again reached Yar Yilaq after crossing the river Zarafshan (known as Kohik River in Babur's time) below Rabat-i-Khwaja. While dawn had arrived his dream to get back to Samarkand was fading away in a distant dusk.